

2c. Content of Exploring poetry and Shakespeare (02)

For this component, learners study a themed poetry cluster from the OCR Poetry Anthology and a Shakespeare play.

There is a choice of three poetry clusters for study, each comprising fifteen poems since 1789, some of which are from the English literary heritage, including Romantic poetry, alongside modern poems and poems from around the world. The poems have been carefully selected to provide a balanced and diverse collection for study.

The focus is on learners taking a skills-based approach to engaging with and responding critically to poetry,

including comparing poems and responding to unseen poetry. Learners explore a Shakespeare play through engaging with key themes and ideas, characterisation and settings. This is underpinned by understanding of the language and how society and culture are presented in the play.

The following tables set out the content of GCSE (9–1) in English Literature, Section A and Section B for component 02. These provide details on the required knowledge, understanding and skills as well as expected breadth and depth of texts studied.
